Welcome to Northwind Labs

Northwind Labs builds measurement software for field researchers. This handbook explains how we work, what you can expect from us and what we expect from you. It applies to every full-time and part-time employee in every office and remote location.

If something in this handbook conflicts with local employment law, the law wins. Questions about any policy can be sent to the People team at people@northwind.example.

Working hours

The standard working week is 40 hours. Core hours are 10:00 to 16:00 in your local time zone; you are expected to be reachable during core hours and may arrange the remaining hours around them.

Overtime is not expected. If a project requires extra hours, your manager must approve them in advance, and the time is returned as paid time off within the same quarter.

Vacation

New full-time employees get 15 paid vacation days a year, earned at 1.25 days per month from their start date. Part-time employees accrue vacation in proportion to their contracted hours.

After three full years of service the allowance rises to 20 days, and up to 5 unused days can be carried over into the next year. Carried-over days expire on 31 March.

Vacation requests of more than five consecutive days should be submitted at least four weeks ahead so that teams can plan coverage.

Sick leave and family leave

Every employee receives 10 paid sick days per year. A doctor's note is required once an absence passes 3 consecutive days.

Primary caregivers receive 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave. Secondary caregivers receive 6 weeks. Leave can be taken at any point during the first 12 months after a child joins the family.

Bereavement leave is 5 paid days for an immediate family member and 2 paid days for extended family.

Travel and expenses

Business expenses are reimbursed within 30 days of submission through the expense portal. Receipts are required for any single expense above $25.

Meals during business travel are capped at $75 per day. Hotels are reimbursed up to $220 per night. Flights must be booked in economy class unless the flight is longer than eight hours.

Personal expenses, minibar charges and entertainment are not reimbursable.

Equipment and security

Laptops are refreshed every 3 years. A lost or stolen device must be reported to the IT desk within 24 hours so that it can be wiped remotely.

Two-factor authentication is mandatory on all company accounts. Passwords must be stored in the company password manager and never shared over chat or email.

Performance reviews

Performance reviews take place twice per year, in June and December. Each review combines a self-assessment, feedback from at least three colleagues and a conversation with your manager.

Salary adjustments are decided after the December review and take effect on 1 February.